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October 2, 2026

City of Boulder Hiring Team
Planning & Development Services

RE: GIS, PLANNING & DEVELOPMENT SERVICES

Dear Hiring Team,

I'm applying for this role because it's less a career move than a homecoming — to a discipline, and to a city. **GIS was the first professional language I ever learned, and Boulder is the place I've chosen to build a life. This role is the rare chance to put both back at the center of my work at the same time.**

My GIS roots go back to my BA in Geography, with Honors, from Colgate, where my thesis used spatial statistics — kriging, IDW, local Moran's I — to model real-world patterns. From there I spent three years on the National Park Service's Digital Maps team, building wildfire-perimeter and endangered-species mapping tools in ArcGIS, Mapbox, and Carto for park staff who weren't GIS specialists; that cartography work became NPS Park Tiles, the official basemap for park websites. Earlier still, with the Humanitarian OpenStreetMap Team and Cadasta — a land-surveying nonprofit — I did QGIS-based disaster-response mapping and land-registry documentation, and evaluated and vetted field data-collection tools including **Survey123** and **Fulcrum** for that surveying work. Later, at Teren, I worked on spatial analysis and modeling using machine-learning models built from drone and satellite imagery to assess environmental and infrastructure risk.

In between, my career took what might look like a detour through marketing technology, enterprise data consulting, and customer-facing technical roles — but it wasn't wasted time. At Lytics, I worked daily with relational databases, SQL, and Python to validate data and build systems other people could rely on. At Zayo and Homebot, I built the documentation, automation, and cross-team habits that keep technical work usable for people who aren't deep in the data themselves. I'm applying for this role because I want to bring all of that — the GIS foundation and everything I built around it — back to spatial data specifically, instead of carrying it sideways into one more adjacent field.

And I want to bring it here. I've watched Boulder put its values into action in ways that genuinely move me — from how deliberately this city thinks about how people actually want to live, to its willingness to take on the fossil fuel industry directly in court, a case the U.S. Supreme Court recently let move forward rather than quietly letting it die on procedure. That's not an abstract climate commitment; it's a city spending real political capital on it. I'd like my data and GIS work to be in service of that, in the place I already call home.

I'd welcome the opportunity to bring my geospatial background, technical and data skills, and genuine investment in this city to the Planning & Development Services team.

Thank you for considering my application. I'd love the opportunity to talk.

Warmly,

Katrina Engelsted

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